

Romans

Have God's Promises Failed?

What about Israel?

Chapter 9

<https://tinyurl.com/RomeGospel>

<https://tinyurl.com/TeachTheWord>

Faith, Hope, and Love

The Outline - Review

FAITH, chapters 1-8

- 1-3 Sin (GOD's great solution – the **Father** provides)
- 4-5 Salvation (GOD's great gift – the **Son** provides)
- 6-8 Sanctification (GOD's great work – the **Spirit** provides)

HOPE, chapters 9-11

- 9 Israel – Past
- 10 Israel – Present
- 11 Israel - Future

LOVE, chapters 12-16

- Practical Christian Living
- The **Just** shall **live** by **Faith**...

What about the Jew?

How are we to relate?

“What advantage then has the Jew, or what is the profit of circumcision? Much in every way! Chiefly because to them were committed the oracles of God. For what if some did not believe? Shall their unbelief make the faith of God without effect?”

Romans 3:1-3

How are the Gentiles to relate to the Jews?

- This same question was prominent in **Acts 15** and will be answered in Romans chapters 9, 10, and 11.
- The issue behind all of this is a demonstration by God to the world that He keeps His promises.

The Problem (chapter 9)...

- God made promises to physical Jews and, according to Paul's teaching, the bulk of all Jews were unblessed. *How do you reconcile God's faithfulness to those to whom he gave promises when the bulk of them were cut off from those blessings?*

Advantages of the Jews

What Paul has already said about the prototypical Jew

Romans 2:17-29; 3:1-8

- Specifically addressing the **Jew; exemplar of the religious person; who is proud of the law, but not keeping it.**

Basis of Jewish Pride

- Being called a Jew (2:17)
- Relied on the Law, “rest” (2:17)
- Boasting of God (superior attitude, 2:19)
- Knowing God’s Will (2:20)
- Being instructors of the Law (2:21)

But, all men could see their self-righteous hypocrisy

- “For ‘the name of God is blasphemed among the Gentiles because of you’...”** Isaiah 52:5; Ezekiel 36:16-36

Reality counts with God...!

“...but he is a Jew who is one inwardly; and circumcision is that of the heart, in the Spirit, not in the letter...” (v. 2:29) (Deut. 10:16-17)

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Read 2:17 thru 3:8

Were the Jewish people “better” (e.g. culturally) than others?

- Arguably “yes”... compare OT laws about health and living systems vs. others (e.g. hygiene, food restrictions, “keepers of God’s Laws”)
- Jews had set aside the “hope of the Messiah” as the Light (even unto Gentiles) and assumed themselves to be the Light.
- i.e. arrogant conceit
- They had the “form of the Law”, an adaptation of the “original Law”
- Paul uses the very Law the Jew trusts in to “root him out”....

Note: Historically, the Church had begun in the Jewish community; most of the early Christians (in the years after pentecost) were Jews. But, here we are 30-40 years since then and the Church had largely become a Gentile phenomenon. Paul (as he traveled and preached in the synagogues) undoubtedly faced a hostile, taunting, perhaps demeaning audience of Jews. Hence, his focus on a Jewish centered argument from that perspective.

- Sub-argument (circumcision is of the heart – Deut 10:16):
- The Jew (*being* circumcised under the law) would not receive covering under the law *without* obedience...
 - And, the Gentile (*not being* circumcised under the law) could receive covering under the law *with* obedience (argument from v. 2:13)...
 - Therefore, the Jew would argue (tauntingly).... **Romans 3:1-8**
 - What advantage is there in being a Jew...? If we are made right with God by His Grace alone, then...
 - Isn’t it the case then that our unrighteousness further increase God’s glory...?
 - Discuss Job 38:1-3; Job 40:2; Job 40:8**
 - Discuss Psalm 51:4
 - (similar argument today – is baptism really necessary then?)

The Starting Place of Faith (God’s Truth is not determined by our assessment of it...):

- 3:3 “Let God be true and every man a liar...”
 - We all know about truth because we all comprehend what a lie is... (the negative reveals the positive)
- 3:4 Men are judging God...! (Psalm 51:4) Man says... “God doesn’t have the right to judge me...! I am as he has made me...” Discuss Job 40:8
- 3:5-9 Paul assents to their argument and then demonstrates how the argument can’t be true because it contradicts God’s own nature... (How can a perfectly just God not apply justice?)
- Sin is born of motivation....! Who is really good?

Isaiah 52:5
5 And now, what do we have here?” says the LORD. “Indeed my people have been carried away for nothing, those who rule over them taunt,” says the LORD, “and my name is constantly slandered all day long.

Ezekiel 36:16-36

16 The LORD’s message came to me: **17** “Son of man, when the house of Israel was living on their own land, they defiled it by their behavior and their deeds. In my sight their behavior was like the uncleanness of a woman having her monthly period. **18** So I poured my anger on them because of the blood they shed on the land and because of the idols

with which they defiled it. **19** I scattered them among the nations; they were dispersed throughout foreign countries. In accordance with their behavior and their deeds I judged them. **20** But when they arrived in the nations where they went, they profaned my holy name. It was said of them, 'These are the people of the LORD, yet they have departed from his land.' **21** I was concerned for my holy reputation which the house of Israel profaned among the nations where they went. **22** "Therefore say to the house of Israel, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: It is not for your sake that I am about to act, O house of Israel, but for the sake of my holy reputation which you profaned among the nations where you went. **23** I will magnify my great name that has been profaned among the nations, that you have profaned among them. The nations will know that I am the LORD, declares the Sovereign LORD, when I magnify myself among you in their sight. **24** "'I will take you from the nations and gather you from all the countries; then I will bring you to your land. **25** I will sprinkle you with pure water and you will be clean from all your impurities. I will purify you from all your idols. **26** I will give you a new heart, and I will put a new spirit within you. I will remove the heart of stone from your body and give you a heart of flesh. **27** I will put my Spirit within you; I will take the initiative and you will obey my statutes and carefully observe my regulations. **28** Then you will live in the land I gave to your fathers; you will be my people, and I will be your God. **29** I will save you from all your uncleanness. I will call for the grain and multiply it; I will not bring a famine on you. **30** I will multiply the fruit of the trees and the produce of the fields, so that you will never again suffer the disgrace of famine among the nations. **31** Then you will remember your evil behavior and your deeds which were not good; you will loathe yourselves on account of your sins and your abominable deeds. **32** Understand that it is not for your sake I am about to act, declares the Sovereign LORD. Be ashamed and embarrassed by your behavior, O house of Israel. **33** "'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: In the day I cleanse you from all your sins, I will populate the cities and the ruins will be rebuilt. **34** The desolate land will be plowed, instead of being desolate in the sight of everyone who passes by. **35** They will say, "This desolate land has become like the garden of Eden; the ruined, desolate, and destroyed cities are now fortified and inhabited." **36** Then the nations which remain around you will know that I, the LORD, have rebuilt the ruins and replanted what was desolate. I, the LORD, have spoken – and I will do it!'

Deuteronomy 10:16-17

16 Therefore, cleanse your heart and stop being so stubborn! **17** For the LORD your God is God of gods and Lord of lords, the great, mighty, and awesome God who is unbiased and takes no bribe,

Advantages of the Jews (9:3-5)

1. **Received the Words of God** (Romans 3:1-2).
2. **Called "Israelites" → "Princes of God"** (Genesis 32:28)
 1. Why chosen? As a witness of His reality.
 2. All nations had excluded knowledge of God (Rom. 1:18-26)
 3. God called a Sumerian named Abram – for His purposes
3. **"Adoption"** as sons (Deut. 7:6-9)
4. **"Glory"; "Shekinah"** (Exodus 24:16-17; 29:43; 40:34-38)
5. **"Covenants"** (Conditional? Unconditional?)
 1. *Abrahamic* (Genesis 12:1-3; 15:6-21)
 1. God's plan for mankind follows from this covenant – Gal 3:8
 2. Eternal – Gen. 17:7; 1 Chron. 16:17;
 3. Re-confirmed – Gen. 22:15-18; Gen. 26:2-5; Heb. 6:13-20
 2. *Land* (Genesis 12:7; 13:12-17; 15:9-21; 35:9-12)
 3. *Mosaic* (was a conditional covenant)
 1. Deut. 28:63-68; 30:1-3 Lev. 26:40-45
 4. *Davidic* (Gen. 49:10; 2 Samuel 7:11-16; 1 Chron. 17:11-14)
 1. Jeconiah was the last of David's line to rule (Jer. 22:30)
 2. Confirmed of Jesus to Mary by Gabriel (Luke 1:30-33)
 3. Recognized by Church Council (Acts 15:16-18)

Advantages of the Jews (9:3-5)

6. **Giving of the Law** (Rom. 7; Gal. 3:17-18)
7. **Service of God** (e.g. temple services)
8. **Special Promises**
9. **Fathers of the Faith** (e.g. Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob)
10. **The Messiah**

The Everlasting Covenant...

- *Jeremiah 31:31-34*
- *Hebrews 8:6-13*
- *Was this promise made to the Jews only?*

Did God's Promises Fail?

How does Paul deal with the “failure” of God's promises?

*“But it is not that the word of God has taken no effect. For they are not all Israel who are of Israel, nor are they all children because they are the seed of Abraham; but, ‘In Isaac your seed shall be called.’ That is, those who are the children of the flesh, these are not the children of God; but the children of the promise are counted as the seed. For this is the word of promise: ‘At this time I will come and Sarah shall have a son.’” **Romans 9:6-9***

The Problem (chapter 9)...

- God made promises to physical Jews and, according to Paul's teaching, the bulk of all Jews were unblessed. *How do you reconcile God's faithfulness to those to whom he gave promises when the bulk of them were cut off from those blessings?*
- Paul insists that the real Israel to whom the promises were to be fulfilled was not synonymous with the whole nation of Israel.
- Paul claims that the real heirs are children of faith (i.e. the believers) and promise (i.e. as Isaac was) and so the rejection of the unbelievers is not a breach of promise on God's part.

GOD's Promises

How the LORD delights in keeping his promises...!

Genesis 15:6

- Abraham was **reckoned** to righteousness **by his faith** when he was still a Gentile, two chapters before the covenant sign of circumcision was placed upon his flesh and 400+ years before the Mosaic Law.
- At the time Abraham was “saved” he wasn’t “Jewish”. (Rom 4:9-12)
- Abraham **did no works** to acquire righteousness, it was by a gift of grace. (Romans 4:4)

The Lord delights in keeping His promises...

- Galatians 3:15-29

Jacob's heirs include “all believers”...

- Promises extended first to the Jew (Romans 1:16) then to the Gentile – but only to those who believe by faith as Abraham did.
- The Israelite without faith was never regarded as a partaker of the promises. Galatians 3:16-18
- John 8:31-47; Deuteronomy 18:15-19; Acts 3:21-23

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The Promises of GOD are the currency upon which man-kind's ultimate hope and destiny rest. Discuss how GOD made promises to Abraham, Moses and the Israelites, and to us (Jer 31:31).

Galatians 3:15-18

15 Brothers and sisters, I offer an example from everyday life: When a covenant has been ratified, even though it is only a human contract, no one can set it aside or add anything to it. **16** Now the promises were spoken to Abraham and to his descendant. Scripture does not say, “and to the descendants,” referring to many, but “**and to your descendant**,” referring to one, who is Christ. **17** What I am saying is this: The law that came four hundred thirty years later does not cancel a covenant previously ratified by God, so as to invalidate the promise. **18** For if the inheritance is based on the law, it is no longer based on the promise, but God graciously gave it to Abraham through the promise.

Galatians 3:19-29

19 Why then was the law given? It was added because of transgressions, until the arrival of the descendant to whom the promise had been made. It was administered through angels by an intermediary. **20** Now an intermediary is not for one party alone, but God is one. **21** Is the law therefore opposed to the promises of God? Absolutely not! For if a law had been given that was able to give life, then righteousness would certainly have come by the law. **22** But the scripture imprisoned everything under sin so that the promise could be given – because of the faithfulness of Jesus Christ – to those who believe. **23** Now before

faith came we were held in custody under the law, being kept as prisoners until the coming faith would be revealed. **24** Thus the law had become our guardian until Christ, so that we could be declared righteous by faith. **25** But now that faith has come, we are no longer under a guardian. **26** For in Christ Jesus you are all sons of God through faith. **27** For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ. **28** There is neither Jew nor Greek, there is neither slave nor free, there is neither male nor female – for all of you are one in Christ Jesus. **29** And if you belong to Christ, then you are Abraham’s descendants, heirs according to the promise.

Deuteronomy 18:15-19

15 The LORD your God will raise up for you a prophet like me from among you – from your fellow Israelites; you must listen to him. **16** This accords with what happened at Horeb in the day of the assembly. You asked the LORD your God: “Please do not make us hear the voice of the LORD our God any more or see this great fire any more lest we die.” **17** The LORD then said to me, “What they have said is good. **18** I will raise up a prophet like you for them from among their fellow Israelites. I will put my words in his mouth and he will speak to them whatever I command. **19** I will personally hold responsible anyone who then pays no attention to the words that prophet speaks in my name.

Acts 3:21-23

21 This one heaven must receive until the time all things are restored, which God declared from times long ago through his holy prophets. **22** Moses said, ***‘The Lord your God will raise up for you a prophet like me from among your brothers. You must obey him in everything he tells you. 23 Every person who does not obey that prophet will be destroyed and thus removed from the people.’***

What shall we say then?

Perhaps just what the eye-witnesses said...

*“What shall we say then? That Gentiles, who did not pursue righteousness, have attained to righteousness, even the righteousness of faith; but Israel, pursuing the law of righteousness, has not attained to the law of righteousness. Why? **Because they did not seek it by faith, but as it were, by the works of the law.** For they stumbled at that stumbling stone. As it is written: ‘**Behold, I lay in Zion a stumbling stone and rock of offense, And whoever believes on Him will not be put to shame.**’” Romans 9:30-33*

*“This is the ‘stone which was rejected by you builders, which has become the chief cornerstone.’ **Nor is there salvation in any other, for there is no other name under heaven given among men by which we must be saved.**” Acts 4:11-12*